

Assignment
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Primitive Root:

A number g is called a primitive root modulo n

if g is a generator of the multiplicative group of integers modulo n

That means: $g^k \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$

only when $k = \phi(n)$

when $\phi(n)$ is Euler's totient function

In other words,

the smallest positive integer k for which $g^k \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$

Example 1

Find a primitive root modulo 7

$$\phi(7) = 6$$

Check possible $g = 2, 3, 4, 5$

$$2^1 = 2, 2^2 = 4, 2^3 = 8 \equiv 1 \pmod{7} \Rightarrow \text{not prime}$$

$$3^1 = 3, 3^2 = 2, 3^3 = 6, 3^4 = 4, 3^5 = 5, 3^6 = 1$$

Since $3^6 \equiv 1$ and no smaller power gives 1
3 is a primitive root mod 7